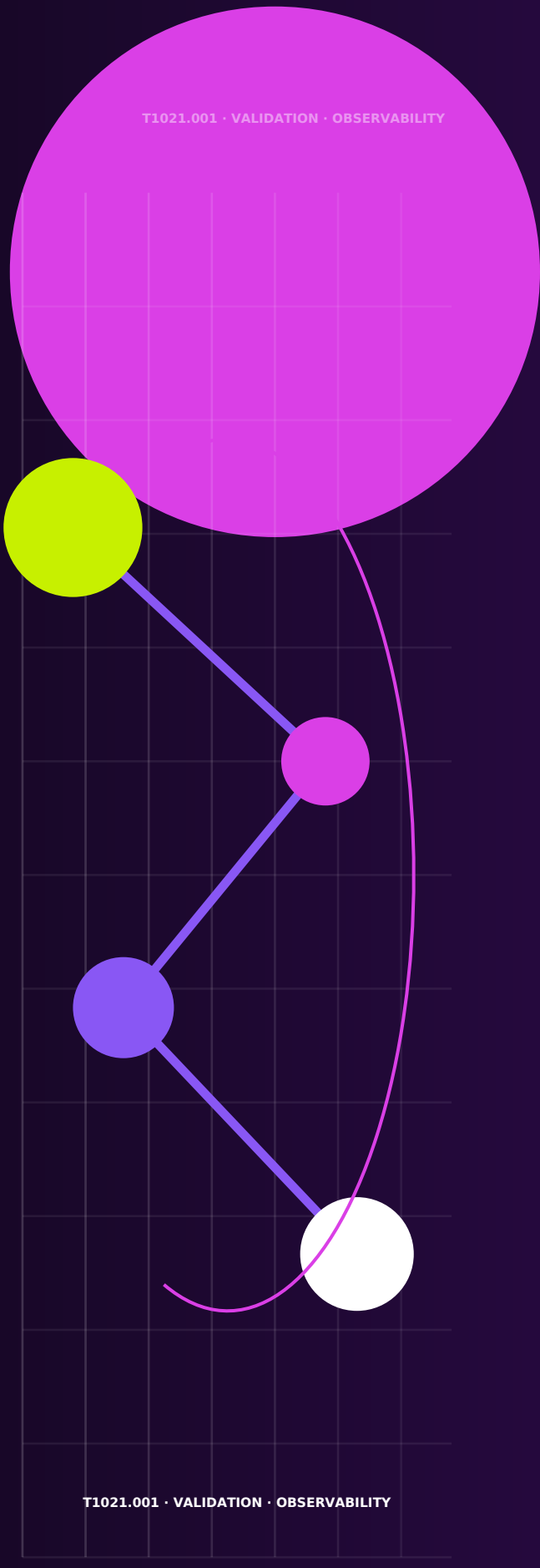
# NIGHTEAGLE - RDP VIRTUAL CHANNEL SCHEMA

Validates collection and raw representation of RdpCoreTS event IDs 132 and 148 before designing content logic for rdp2tcp or attacker-selected virtual-channel names.




VALIDATION QUERY

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM

REPORT TYPE
campaign

STATUS
Untested implementation sketch

PRIMARY PLATFORM
Microsoft Sentinel / Log Analytics

OPERATIONAL VALUE
10 / 10

01

# Executive Assessment

Decision-grade summary with explicit evidence boundaries.

ASSESSMENT

**DECISION**

Retain this package as a validation query and migrate it to the canonical visual and evidence contract without changing query conditions. Treat every result as an investigative lead until local schema, field population, benign overlap and the legacy claim provenance are reviewed.

### LEGACY EVIDENCE RECORD

- The retained legacy source ledger contains 5 normalized references; claim-to-source mapping remains...

### ANALYST ASSESSMENT

- The existing logic is retained at validation maturity; repository migration is not execution eviden...
- The folder and query header map the package to T1021.001 / T1090; operational relevance still depend...

### DETECTION ASSUMPTIONS

- The named telemetry is collected across the intended asset or identity scope with adequate...
- Projected fields preserve their expected semantics in the target connector and parser. [C002]
- Approved activity, owners and change records are available to analysts during disposition. [C003]

## KEY FINDINGS

### FINDING 1

The original query conditions and source ledger were preserved during layout migration; legacy PDF SHA-256 e687c938c8b8f8fb... is recorded for traceability. [C001]

### FINDING 2

The principal observable is Evaluate Event for rdp virtual channel schema using the existing source-derived conditions while preserving projected investigation context. [C002]

### FINDING 3

The evidence boundary remains explicit: a match does not prove It does not establish malicious rdp2tcp use. [C003]

**EVIDENCE BOUNDARY**

A matching result does not prove It does not establish malicious rdp2tcp use. Target-environment field population, benign prevalence, parser behavior and operational ownership have not been validated by this repository migration.

02

# Threat Mechanics

Technical mechanism, observable transitions and supported scope.

ATTACK FLOW

### TECHNICAL BACKGROUND

The retained dossier links Nighteagle to the detection opportunity described as rdp virtual channel schema. The v2 migration preserves the query exactly and exposes its match boundary, but does not reinterpret legacy source claims as laboratory evidence. Evaluate Event for rdp virtual channel schema using the existing source-derived conditions while preserving projected investigation context. [C001][C002]

1

### THREAT CONTEXT

Validates collection and raw representation of RdpCoreTS event IDs 132 and 148 before designing content logic for rdp2tcp or attacker-selected virtual-channel names. Observable: Context retained from the legacy dossier and source ledger.

2

### OBSERVABLE CANDIDATE

Evaluate Event for rdp virtual channel schema using the existing source-derived conditions while preserving projected investigation context. Observable: Events from Event and projected fields.

3

### CONTEXTUAL ENRICHMENT

Resolve asset, identity, process, ownership and change context before disposition. Observable: Raw event, surrounding timeline, inventory and authorized-change evidence.

4

### DECISION GATE

Escalate only when corroborating evidence closes the documented non-claim boundary. Observable: Controlled validation, explainable negatives and analyst-readable evidence.

03

# Telemetry & Evidence Model

Minimum data contract and known visibility gaps.

DATA CONTRACT

**PRIMARY PLATFORM**

Microsoft Sentinel / Log Analytics. Evaluate Event for rdp virtual channel schema using the existing source-derived conditions while preserving projected investigation context.

| FIELD / TABLE | STATUS | PURPOSE |
| --- | --- | --- |
| **Event** | **Required** | Primary event source selected by the unchanged query logic. |
| **Event time and entity identifiers** | **Required** | Chronology, deduplication, scoping and investigation pivots. |
| **Raw projected context** | **Required** | Preserve the fields emitted by the query before normalization or tuning. |
| **Asset, identity and change inventory** | **Enrichment** | Separate authorized activity and define operational ownership. |

**KNOWN VISIBILITY GAPS**

Unvalidated local schema Missing projected fields Incomplete retention or asset scope Mutable attacker behavior Legacy claim provenance review pending

04

# Primary Detection Logic

Native query, explicit condition evidence and match meaning.

KQL

```
// Rule: [T1021.001][T1090] Nighteagle - RDP Virtual Channel Schema
// MITRE ATT&CK: T1021.001, T1090
// Classification: Validation query
// Status: Untested implementation sketch
// Primary platform: Microsoft Sentinel / Log Analytics
// Required telemetry: Event
// Purpose: Validates collection and raw representation of RdpCoreTS event IDs 132 and 148 before designing content logic for rdp2tcp or attacker-s
// Logic: Evaluate Event for rdp virtual channel schema using the existing source-derived conditions while preserving projected investigation conte
// A match proves: A result proves that the published query conditions matched in Event; it is an investigative event, not a malicious verdict.
// A match does not prove: It does not establish malicious rdp2tcp use.
// Expected false positives: authorized administration, approved software, testing, or benign artifact collisions.
// Coverage limits: local schema, field population, retention, collection scope, and attacker variation require validation.
// Evidence claims: C001, C002, C003
//
// NightEagle / rdp2tcp virtual-channel telemetry validation
// Validation query - Untested implementation sketch
// Primary platform: Microsoft Sentinel / Log Analytics
// Required telemetry: Azure Monitor Agent DCR collecting
// Microsoft-Windows-RemoteDesktopServices-RdpCoreTS/Operational into Event
// Confidence: Medium
// A result establishes event collection only. It does not establish malicious rdp2tcp use.

Event
| where EventLog == "Microsoft-Windows-RemoteDesktopServices-RdpCoreTS/Operational"
| where EventID in (132, 148)
| project TimeGenerated, Computer, EventID, EventLog, Source,
          RenderedDescription, EventData, ParameterXml,
          UserName, _ResourceId
| order by TimeGenerated desc
```

### WHAT A MATCH PROVES

A result proves that the published query conditions matched in Event; it is an investigative event, not a malicious verdict.

### WHAT IT DOES NOT PROVE

It does not establish malicious rdp2tcp use.

### MATURITY

Validation query - Untested implementation sketch. Evaluate Event for rdp virtual channel schema using the existing source-derived conditions while preserving projected investigation context.

05

# Triage & Hunting Playbook

Evidence-preserving workflow from match to disposition.

WORKFLOW

**01**

Preserve the complete raw matching event, query version, timestamp, connector or sensor version and stable entity identifiers.

**02**

Confirm the event originated from the intended Microsoft Sentinel / Log Analytics data source and verify the semantics of every condition used by the query.

**03**

Resolve asset, identity, process, software and destination ownership against authoritative inventories and approved change records.

**04**

Build the surrounding endpoint, identity, network or appliance timeline and seek an independent evidence layer before escalation.

**05**

Classify benign overlap explicitly; tune only with durable ownership or provenance controls, never by suppressing the core behavior globally.

**06**

Escalate only when corroborating evidence establishes malicious or unauthorized activity beyond the documented match boundary.

**DISPOSITION RULE**

Escalate only when the evidence establishes the behavior described by the query. It does not establish malicious rdp2tcp use.

06

# False Positives & Validation

Overlap model, controlled checks and promotion gate.

QUALITY GATE

### AUTHORIZED ADMINISTRATION OR SOFTWARE

Require owner, purpose, approved change and expected execution or configuration provenance.

### BENIGN ARTIFACT OR COMMAND COLLISION

Require the full condition set plus an independent evidence layer or stable provenance.

### PARSER, INVENTORY OR RETENTION AMBIGUITY

Reproduce a controlled event and reconcile raw fields, collection scope and authoritative inventory.

## VALIDATION SEQUENCE

- Generate an authorized controlled equivalent of the primary observable without using live malicious infrastructure.
- Verify each query condition and projected field against retained raw telemetry.
- Run representative approved and near-match negative controls.
- Measure historical prevalence and classify every returned owner or workflow.
- Record parser, connector, retention and asset-scope dependencies with the test evidence.

### SUCCESS

The controlled positive produces a complete, explainable row and representative negatives are separable through durable context.

### REJECTION

Reject promotion when field semantics, collection scope, benign ownership or the core behavior cannot be established reproducibly.

### PROMOTION GATE

Require claim-level source review, a retained controlled positive, representative negatives, measured prevalence and an accountable operational owner.

07

# Analyst Assessment & References

Coverage statement, open questions and source record.

FINAL

**CONCLUSION**

This package now uses the canonical v2 layout and evidence contract while preserving the original validation.kql conditions. It remains a validation query at medium confidence. The visual migration is complete; claim-level provenance and target-environment execution remain explicit promotion gates.

**MITRE ATT&CK**

T1021.001 / T1090

## PRIMARY AND AUTHORITATIVE REFERENCES

**S001 securelist.com - Kaspersky Global Emergency Response Team, "NightEagle targets Russian companies," published 2026-09-16; incidents investigated during the preceding year. (2026-09-16)**

hxxps://securelist[.]com/tr/nighteagle-apt-ghostcontainer-and-tunneling/121323/

**S002 Microsoft Learn - Microsoft, Azure Monitor Logs reference - Event; accessed 2026-09-18; page last updated 2026-07-28. (2026-09-16)**

hxxps://learn[.]microsoft[.]com/en-us/azure/azure-monitor/reference/tables/event

**S003 Microsoft Learn - Microsoft, Azure Monitor Logs reference - Event; accessed 2026-09-18; page last updated 2026-07-28. (2026-09-16)**

hxxps://learn[.]microsoft[.]com/en-us/azure/azure-monitor/vm/data-collection-windows-events

**S004 MITRE ATT&CK - T1021.001 - Remote Services: Remote Desktop Protocol. (2026-09-18)**

hxxps://attack[.]mitre[.]org/techniques/T1021/001/

**S005 MITRE ATT&CK - T1021.001 - Remote Services: Remote Desktop Protocol. (2026-09-18)**

hxxps://attack[.]mitre[.]org/techniques/T1090/

**OPEN QUESTIONS**

A matching result does not prove It does not establish malicious rdp2tcp use. Target-environment field population, benign prevalence, parser behavior and operational ownership have not been validated by this repository migration.

**DOCUMENT CONTROL**

Schema 2.0 | Layout 2.0 | Maturity validation | Confidence Medium | No customer data | Evidence ledger required